

ALS OF 2023

● LENSkart LED IN 2023 WITH A \$500-MILLION FUNDRAISE

COMPANY	SECTOR	INVESTORS	AMOUNT (\$ MN)	DATE
Infra.Market	Online Services (Marketplace - Construction Materials)	Varde Partners	150	06/23
Zetwerk	Online Services (Marketplace - B2B - Manufacturing Services)	Avenir Growth	150	05/23
Insurance Dekho	Online Services (Marketplace - Insurance)	Avataar Venture Partners, Invest-Corp Group, Leap-Frog, TVS Capital, Goldman Sachs, Others	150	01/23
Ola Electric	Automobiles (Electric Vehicles)	Tiger Global, Temasek, Others	140	09/23
KreditBee	Online Services (Loans - E-Commerce Purchases By Students)	Advent International, Others	120	01/23

*DATA AS OF DECEMBER 15, 2023 SOURCE VENTURE INTELLIGENCE

In 2023, deal volume fell to 569 from 1,295 in 2021, and deal value dwindled to one-fifth of its 2021 zenith, standing at \$7.5 billion compared to the previous \$35.8 billion

| 37

ecosystem, and, if anything, their enthusiasm is steadily growing. Per VC firm Elevation Capital's 'Founder Pulse 2023' report, 83 per cent of surveyed founders believe that now is a good time to be starting up a business in India, with 50 per cent feeling there has never been a better time than the current moment to pursue entrepreneurship. Founders are optimistic that the next five years will usher in record-breaking levels of IPOs and M&As.

It is this optimism and unwavering belief in India's opportunities that drives the 'BT Upstarts: India's Coolest Start-ups' featured in this issue of *Business Today*. Mirroring this enthusiasm, the VC community, too, envisions a turnaround in funding dynamics, hinting at a pos-



"There is a massive shortage of quality companies in the later stages, those ready for IPO or wanting to raise \$100+ million rounds"

RAHUL CHANDRA
FOUNDER & MD, ARKAM VENTURES

sible end to this winter spell.

"Inflation is looking under control and interest rates seem to have plateaued [in the US]; it will move downwards at some point," says Arkam's Chandra, adding that whenever interest rates soften, the shift to equity and other riskier assets is immediate and massive.

As resilient start-ups navigate the challenges, steadfast investors, holding firm faith in India's long-term potential, are gearing up to amplify their support, signalling that the comeback of prosperous times is just around the corner.

In the following pages, read about what the 35 resilient start-ups, featured here, did right. **BT**

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